

Palladio

The enduring fame of Andrea Palladio (1508–80) – who gave his name to an entire style – rests largely on the beautifully proportioned town and country villas he built for rich patrons in and around Venice. As a young man he visited Rome and absorbed the styles of antiquity, particularly the proportions of Greek and Roman temples; he later assimilated the style of the Mannerist Michele Sanmicheli (1484–1559). From his first designs around 1540, Palladio's signature elements became apparent, including paired flanking wings for stables and barns, walled courtyards and arcaded pavements, as well as impeccably symmetrical colonnaded façades. His designs did not call for expensive materials; stuccoed brickwork, hinting at Roman classicism, was a common feature. Published later in life, his *Four Books of Architecture* (1570), summarizing his studies of classical forms, gained him wide recognition, and his *Antiquities of Rome* (1554–6) was for 200 years the standard guidebook to the city. The timeless appeal of Palladian style would be eagerly taken up in 18th-century England.



Villa Foscari near Venice, Palladio, 1558–60